INVENTORY · GRID · STRUCTURE

cards-grid

2–4 parallel items, similar weight, scannable in a grid.

A cards grid gives equal weight to peers.

Parallel titles.

Noun phrases of similar weight, never mixed.

Short bodies.

One clause each; a long card collapses the grid.

Rank order.

Left to right reads strongest first.

Four cards.

The hard ceiling; five means a new slide.

four locks a two-by-two, compact tightens it.

Quadrant read.
Four cells scan as a loop.

Compact pairing.
Padding shrinks so labels stay whole.

Named corners.
Position carries meaning; place cards deliberately.

Still four.
The ceiling does not move.

three widens the grid to three columns.

Wider cards.

Each card earns a third of the row.

Same budget.

Bodies stay one clause, titles stay parallel.

Sweet spot.

Three peers is the count this grid loves.

An ordered list numbers the cards.

1

Numbers appear

Markdown's ordered list turns cards into steps.

2

Sequence reads

The grid now implies order, so mean it.

3

Budget holds

Same one-clause bodies as the unnumbered grid.

Four full cards is this grid's loud maximum.

Card one.

A body at the hard budget runs this long — two clauses that read as one breath, and not a word more.

Card two.

Parallel structure matters most at the ceiling; matching shapes are what keep four dense cards readable as a set.

Card three.

The grid trades white space for words here; past this density the audience reads one card and skips the rest.

Card four.

The hard stop. A fifth card or a longer body does not fit — split the slide or reach for list-tabular.

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When NOT to reach for cards-grid.

More than 4 items

Split into multiple slides instead. The grid loses scannability past 4 cards.

Order carries meaning

Use list-steps or `list takeaway numbered`. cards-grid is for parallel options, not sequences.

When NOT to reach for cards-grid.

Lopsided density

Equalize the prose when one card has three sentences and the rest have one. Otherwise change layout.

Inline-code-only body

A body bullet containing only `code` gets promoted to an eyebrow label. Mix it with surrounding prose.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`list-steps` — items carry an explicit sequence

`cards-stack` — items stack vertically as full-width rows

`compare-prose` — two-option comparison, side by side

`verdict-grid` — comparing options against shared criteria